PRACTICAL PLAYBOOK

Never Miss Another Job

The HVAC Owner's Guide to Building AI-Powered Business Systems - Without Hiring Staff or Buying Expensive Software

Build Systems

Never Miss Leads

Grow Revenue

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CHAPTER 01

The $50,000 You're Leaving on the Table

Let's do some math you're not going to like.

You probably give 8-10 quotes a week. Industry data says the average HVAC booking rate is 42%. That means more than half the people who call you end up hiring someone else.

Not because you're bad at your job. Because you're under a house when they call back. Because you meant to follow up on that $8,000 install quote on Friday and it's now three weeks later. Because the homeowner went with the guy who texted them the next morning.

At an average repair ticket of $350 and install tickets between $5,000 and $12,500 - losing even two or three jobs a week to slow follow-up adds up to **$50,000+ per year in revenue you earned but never collected.**

58%

of leads never get a follow-up

$350

average repair ticket

$50K+

lost annually to missed follow-ups

The "Too Busy Working to Grow" Trap

Here's what your day actually looks like: wake up, check the schedule, drive to the first call, diagnose the problem, fix it, write up the invoice, drive to the next one. Somewhere in there you're supposed to answer new leads, follow up on old quotes, post on social media, and plan for the slow season.

You don't. Because you're doing the work. And the work never stops.

One HVAC owner on Reddit put it perfectly: "Admin work can easily take more time than the actual jobs." Another said his company grew so fast he was "struggling with the workload and terrified of burning out." A third was told that only 2% of techs who go solo actually make it - "everybody else folds because they can't keep up during the slow season."

The Real Problem Isn't Skill - It's Systems

You know HVAC. You're good at it. The furnace doesn't scare you. The 110-degree attic doesn't scare you. What's killing your business is everything around the work: the follow-ups you forget, the quotes that go cold, the marketing you never do, the customers you lose track of.

Big companies solve this by hiring. They have dispatchers, office managers, marketing coordinators, and sales teams. They pay $250-500 per tech per month for software like ServiceTitan. That's fine when you're running 10 trucks. When it's just you and maybe a helper, that math doesn't work.

What If You Could Build Those Systems Yourself?

Not hire them. Not buy expensive software for them. Build them. Yourself. For $20 a month or less.

That's what this book is about. Each chapter gives you a business system - a repeatable, AI-powered process that handles the admin, follow-ups, marketing, and sales work you don't have time for. You build each one using tools like ChatGPT or Claude (both have free versions). Every prompt you need is included. Copy, paste, fill in your details, done.

You're not learning about AI. You're building the business systems that separate the shops that grow from the shops that stay stuck.

WHAT YOU'LL BUILD

- **A Lead Capture System** that ensures no quote goes more than 48 hours without follow-up
- **A Customer Memory System** that replaces a $250/month CRM
- **A Marketing Engine** that fills your shoulder seasons
- **A Sales Closer System** that lands the big installs
- **A Daily Operating System** that runs it all in 15 minutes a day from your phone

"You don't need more hours. You need better systems. And now you can build them yourself."

CHAPTER 02

Build Your Lead Capture System

48 hrs

max time before follow-up

3

touches per lead. No more guessing.

The Problem

A homeowner finds you on Google. They call. You're on a roof. They leave a voicemail. You get back to them at 8 PM - but they already called two other companies and booked the one that answered.

Or this: you give a quote for a $9,000 system replacement. The homeowner says "let me talk to my wife." You mean to follow up Thursday. Three weeks go by. They went with someone else. Not because he was cheaper. Because he followed up.

This isn't a skill problem. It's a system problem. And you're about to fix it.

The 48-Hour Lead Lock

Here's the rule: no lead goes more than 48 hours without hearing from you. Every lead gets exactly 3 touches. You don't have to think about what to say - you paste a prompt, get the message, send it. Done from the truck in 30 seconds.

Touch 1: Same-Day Response

Someone called, emailed, or submitted a form. Send this within 2 hours:

COPY THIS PROMPT

```
Write a friendly text message for a new HVAC lead. Keep it under 50 words, casual tone.

Context:
- They contacted me about: [AC not cooling / furnace issue / new system quote / maintenance]
- Their name: [first name]
- How they found me: [Google / Nextdoor / referral from ___]

Sound like a real person, not a company. End with a question to keep the conversation going.
```

EXAMPLE OUTPUT

"Hey Sarah! Got your message about the AC. That's miserable in this heat - I've got an opening tomorrow afternoon if that works? I can take a look and give you an honest assessment. What time works best for you?"

Touch 2: Quote Follow-Up (48 Hours)

You gave them a number. They said "let me think about it." Two days later:

COPY THIS PROMPT

```
Write a casual follow-up text for an HVAC quote I gave 2 days ago. Under 60 words.

Context:
- Customer: [name]
- Job: [AC replacement / furnace repair / ductwork / etc.]
- Quote amount: [$X,XXX]
- What they seemed concerned about: [price / timing / whether to repair vs replace]

Don't be pushy. Add one piece of useful info (rebate, financing, seasonal timing). End with an easy question.
```

Touch 3: The Final Nudge (Week 2)

If they haven't responded, one last message. Give them an easy out - nobody likes being chased.

COPY THIS PROMPT

```
Write a final follow-up text for an HVAC lead that's gone quiet for 2 weeks. Under 50 words.

Context:
- Customer: [name]
- Original job: [description]
- Quote: [$X,XXX]

Tone: genuinely helpful, not desperate. Acknowledge they might have gone another direction and that's fine. Leave the door open. No guilt trips.
```

Weekly Pipeline Review

Every Sunday, take 5 minutes to review all open leads:

COPY THIS PROMPT

```
Here are my open HVAC leads. For each one, tell me: (1) what touch they're on, (2) what I should do next, (3) draft the message.

[Paste your lead list - name, job, quote amount, last contact date, status]

Flag anyone over 48 hours without contact as URGENT.
```

THE SYSTEM IN PRACTICE

Every lead gets 3 touches. No exceptions. No thinking required. Open ChatGPT, paste the prompt, fill in the details, send the text. Total time per lead: 30 seconds. Total leads saved per month: even if it's just 2-3, at $350-$9,000 each, that's your ChatGPT subscription paid for a hundred times over.

CHAPTER 03

Build Your Customer Memory System

The Problem

The Johnsons call. You've been to their house three times. You can't remember if they have a Carrier or a Lennox, when you last changed the filter, or whether you told them the compressor was on its way out.

Meanwhile, you know at least a dozen customers are probably due for a furnace tune-up before winter. But figuring out who would mean digging through a year of invoices, texts, and sticky notes. So you don't. And those customers call someone else - or worse, they don't call anyone, and their furnace dies in January.

ServiceTitan solves this. For $250-500 per tech per month. Housecall Pro does it for $59-149. Even Jobber starts at $25.

Or you can build the same thing for free.

The AI Customer Brain

You already have the data. It's in your texts, invoices, notes app, maybe a spreadsheet. The problem isn't missing information - it's that it's scattered everywhere. AI turns the mess into a system.

Prompt 1: Build a Customer Profile

After every job, dump your notes and let AI organize them:

COPY THIS PROMPT

```
Organize these notes into a customer profile:

[Paste your texts, invoice notes, or voice memo transcript about this customer]

Format:
- Name:
- Address:
- Equipment: (brand, model, age if known)
- Service history: (date  -  what was done)
- Issues noted: (anything flagged for future)
- Next maintenance due:
- Notes: (preferences, pets, gate code, anything useful)
```

Prompt 2: Find Who Needs Maintenance

COPY THIS PROMPT

```
Here's my customer list with their last service dates. It's [current month].

[Paste customer names and last service dates]

Flag everyone who:
1. Hasn't had a tune-up in 12+ months
2. Is coming up on heating season and needs a furnace check
3. Has equipment over 10 years old that might need replacement discussion

For each flagged customer, draft a personalized text message referencing their specific
equipment and last visit.
```

Prompt 3: Re-Engage Cold Customers

COPY THIS PROMPT

```
These customers haven't called in 6+ months:

[Paste names and last service info]

Write a personal re-engagement text for each one. Reference something specific about their
last job. Include a seasonal maintenance offer. Keep each under 60 words. Sound like me
checking in, not a company sending marketing.
```

Prompt 4: Pre-Visit Customer Briefing

COPY THIS PROMPT

```
I'm heading to a service call. Here's what I know about this customer:

[Paste their profile or past notes]

They're calling about: [current issue]

Based on their history, what should I check while I'm there? Any upsell opportunities that
make genuine sense? What's the likely issue given their equipment age and history?
```

WITHOUT THE SYSTEM

"Hey, I'm here for the AC call. Uh, what kind of unit do you have again?" Homeowner thinks: this guy doesn't remember me. Maybe I should get another opinion.

WITH THE SYSTEM

"Hey Mrs. Johnson! Last time I was here we replaced that capacitor on your Carrier. It's been about 14 months - while I'm checking the AC, let me look at the furnace too since winter's coming." Homeowner thinks: this guy knows my house.

THE MATH

ServiceTitan: $250-500/month ($3,000-6,000/year). Housecall Pro: $59-149/month ($700-1,800/year). Jobber: $25-109/month ($300-1,300/year). ChatGPT Pro: $20/month ($240/year). Free version: $0. **Your customer data is already in your phone. AI just organizes it.**

CHAPTER 04

Build Your Marketing Engine

The Problem

June through August, you're slammed. Ten calls a day. You can't keep up. Then September hits and the phone goes quiet. October picks up for furnace season, but November through March? Dead. You're burning through savings wondering if you should have stayed at your old company.

Everyone says "you need to market your business." Great. When? Between the 6 AM start and the 8 PM invoicing? And what do you even post? A picture of a condenser? Nobody cares.

You don't need to become a marketer. You need a machine that produces a month of content in 20 minutes.

The Seasonal Content Machine

Build this once. Reuse it every year. Adjust the details, keep the structure.

Prompt 1: Build Your Annual Calendar

COPY THIS PROMPT

```
Create a 12-month marketing calendar for a small HVAC company in [city/state].

For each month include:
- 1 Google Business Profile post idea (seasonal, helpful)
- 1 Facebook post idea (mix tips with personality)
- 1 email topic for past customers
- Key service to promote that month

Consider: AC season (May-Sep), heating season (Oct-Feb), shoulder seasons (Mar-Apr, Sep-Oct).
Include maintenance agreement pushes during slow months.
```

Prompt 2: Batch Your Monthly Posts

COPY THIS PROMPT

```
Write 4 Google Business Profile posts for my HVAC company for [month].

Business: [your company name] in [city]
This month's focus: [seasonal topic  -  e.g., "AC tune-ups before summer"]

Each post: 100-150 words, helpful tip first, soft call-to-action at the end. Sound like a
local business owner giving advice, not a corporation running ads. No hashtags.
```

Prompt 3: Facebook That Doesn't Sound Like an Ad

COPY THIS PROMPT

```
Write 4 Facebook posts for my HVAC company this month. Mix these types:
1. A helpful tip homeowners can actually use
2. A "behind the scenes" story from a recent job (keep it vague for privacy)
3. A seasonal reminder with a soft offer
4. Something with personality — a hot take, a funny observation, a "you know it's [season]
when..."

Company: [name] in [city]. Keep each under 100 words. No corporate speak. Write like a real
person, not a brand.
```

Prompt 4: Nextdoor That Gets Referrals

COPY THIS PROMPT

```
Write a Nextdoor post for my HVAC business. The goal is to be helpful, not salesy.

Topic: [seasonal — e.g., "signs your AC is struggling before it dies"]
Company: [name]

Write it like a neighbor who happens to be an HVAC tech sharing useful info. Include 3-4
specific things they can check themselves. End with "happy to answer questions" — no hard
sell. Under 150 words.
```

Prompt 5: Monthly Customer Email

COPY THIS PROMPT

```
Write a monthly email to my HVAC customer list.

Month: [month]
Seasonal focus: [topic]
Any current offer: [e.g., "$79 furnace tune-up" or "no current offer"]

Structure: Open with a useful tip (2-3 sentences). Mention the seasonal service. End with a
referral ask ("know someone who needs help? Send them our way"). Keep the whole thing under
150 words. Subject line included.
```

Prompt 6: Google Review Machine

COPY THIS PROMPT

```
Write 3 different Google review request texts I can send customers after completing a job.

Variation 1: Quick and casual (under 30 words)
Variation 2: References the specific work done (include [job type] placeholder)
Variation 3: For a big job where I went above and beyond

Each should include my Google review link: [your link]. Make them feel genuine, not automated.
```

The 20-Minute Monthly Batch: Sunday night, once a month. Open ChatGPT. Paste prompts 2-5. Get all your posts, email, and review templates in one session. Schedule or save them. Total time: 20 minutes for a full month of marketing. That's less time than one service call.

Quick Wins You Can Do Today

1. **Claim your Google Business Profile**
   if you haven't. It's free. 46% of all Google searches are local. This is where homeowners find you.

2. **Ask your last 5 customers for Google reviews.**
   Paste the review request prompt from Chapter 2, fill in their names, send. Takes 3 minutes.

3. **Write your first monthly batch.**
   Paste the Facebook and Google prompts above. You'll have 8 posts ready in 10 minutes. Schedule them or post one per week.

4. **Set a phone reminder:**
   "First Sunday of every month - marketing batch." One recurring reminder. That's all it takes to never go dark on marketing again.

CHAPTER 05

Build Your Sales Closer System

The Problem

You're standing in someone's basement looking at a 20-year-old furnace. You know it needs to be replaced. The homeowner asks how much. You say "$9,500 for a good unit, installed." They say "let me talk to my wife."

And you never hear from them again.

It's not that your price was wrong. It's that $9,500 is scary and you didn't give them a reason to say yes today. You didn't follow up with financing options. You didn't send a professional proposal. You didn't check in three days later when they'd had time to think.

You're leaving the biggest jobs on the table because you're great at diagnosing problems and awkward at closing sales. That's normal. You're a technician, not a salesperson. But you can build a system that does the selling for you.

The 5-Touch Close Sequence

For any job over $3,000, this is your pipeline. Five touches over two weeks. Each one adds value. None of them are pushy.

1. **Same Day: Send the Professional Proposal**
   Don't just give them a verbal number. Send something they can show their spouse. Use this prompt within 2 hours of the visit:

COPY THIS PROMPT

```
Write a professional HVAC proposal for a homeowner. Clean, clear format.

Customer: [name]
Address: [address]
Current system: [brand, model, age, condition]
Issues found: [what's wrong and why replacement/repair is recommended]
Recommended solution: [new system details]
Cost: [$X,XXX]
Includes: [installation, disposal, permit, warranty details]
Financing available: [yes/no  -  if yes, estimated monthly payment]
Timeline: [when you can do the work]

Tone: confident and straightforward. Explain WHY this is the right fix, not just WHAT it
costs. No jargon. A homeowner with zero HVAC knowledge should understand every word.
```

2. **Day 2: Add Value (Don't Ask for the Sale)**
   Send something useful - a rebate they might qualify for, an energy savings calculation, or seasonal timing context.

COPY THIS PROMPT

```
Write a day-2 follow-up text for an HVAC install quote. Under 60 words.

Customer: [name]
Quoted job: [system replacement, $X,XXX]
One useful thing to share: [manufacturer rebate / utility rebate / energy savings estimate /
"if we do it before [season] we avoid the rush"]

Don't ask "have you decided?" Add value. Sound like you thought of them, not like you're
chasing a sale.
```

3 **Day 5: Make the Price Feel Smaller**

The $9,500 is scary. $89/month isn't. If you offer financing, now is when you break it down.

COPY THIS PROMPT

```
Write a text explaining HVAC financing to a homeowner who got a big quote. Under 80 words.

Quote: [$X,XXX]
Financing terms: [X months, X% APR, or "as low as $XX/month"]

Make $[X,XXX] feel manageable. Compare the monthly payment to something relatable (coffee,
streaming subscriptions, their current energy waste). Don't be condescending - just make the
math real.
```

4 **Day 10: Handle the Objection They're Not Saying**

If they haven't responded, they're probably stuck on price. Address it head-on.

COPY THIS PROMPT

```
Write a response to an HVAC customer who thinks the price is too high. Under 100 words.

My quote: [$X,XXX] for [job description]
What they're comparing to: [probably a lowball competitor or DIY option]

Don't cut the price. Reframe the value: warranty, efficiency savings, doing it right the first
time, what happens if the old unit fails mid-winter/summer. Be honest, not defensive.
```

5 **Day 14: The Graceful Close**

Last touch. Make it easy to say yes - or no. No guilt.

COPY THIS PROMPT

```
Write a final follow-up for an HVAC install quote that's 2 weeks old. Under 50 words.

Customer: [name]
Job: [description]

Acknowledge they're busy. Mention one timely reason to act (seasonal rush, rebate expiring,
weather coming). Give them a clear yes-or-no moment. If they say no, wish them well. Leave the
door open.
```

Bonus: The Review Request

Every completed job should get one of these within 24 hours:

COPY THIS PROMPT

```
Write a review request text for an HVAC customer whose job I just completed.

Customer: [name]
Job: [what I did]
Anything special: [went above and beyond / emergency call / quick turnaround]

Keep it under 40 words. Reference the specific work. Include my Google review link: [link].
Make it feel personal, not automated.
```

The math: If you close just one extra install per month that would have gone cold, that's $8,000-12,000 in additional revenue from a system that takes 5 minutes per lead to run. Over a year, that's $96,000-$144,000 in revenue you were already earning but not collecting.

Why This Works (When "Just Follow Up" Doesn't)

You already know you should follow up. The problem was never knowledge - it was friction. Thinking about what to say. Worrying about sounding desperate. Not having time to sit down and write something thoughtful.

This system removes all of that. The prompts do the thinking. You just fill in the blanks and hit send. Each touch is pre-planned so you never wonder "should I text them again?" The sequence handles it. You just run the system.

Most HVAC techs stop after touch 1 - the initial quote. The ones who grow are the ones who stay in front of the customer through touches 2, 3, 4, and 5. Not because they're better salespeople. Because they have a system that does it for them.

CHAPTER 06

Your Daily Operating System

The Problem

You've read business books before. You've listened to podcasts. You've thought "I should do that." And then Monday hits and you're back under a house and none of it happens.

This chapter is different because it's built for your actual day. Not a CEO's day. Not a desk job. Your day - the one that starts at 6 AM and involves crawling through attics and driving between calls.

Everything here runs from your phone. Voice-to-text works great for the prompts. 15 minutes total. Three 5-minute blocks that fit between the work you're already doing.

The HVAC Owner's Daily 15

Morning: 5 Minutes From the Truck

Before you start driving. Coffee in hand. Open ChatGPT.

COPY THIS PROMPT

```
Here are my jobs today:
[List today's schedule - customer name, address, job type]

And here are my open leads:
[List any leads that need follow-up]

For each job today: is there anything I should mention based on their history? (seasonal
maintenance, past issues, equipment age)
For each open lead: draft a follow-up message if they're over 48 hours without contact.
```

6:30 AM Paste the prompt. Get your prep notes and follow-up texts. Send the texts, skim the notes. **Done by 6:35.**

Between Jobs: 5 Minutes Voice-to-Text

You just finished a call. Before you drive to the next one, talk into your phone:

COPY THIS PROMPT

```
Just finished a job. Log this:

Customer: [name]
Address: [address]
What I did: [quick description]
Equipment: [what they have]
Issues noticed: [anything to flag for next time]
Follow-up needed: [yes/no  -  if yes, what and when]

Now draft:
1. A same-day thank-you text (under 30 words)
2. A Google review request
3. Update their customer profile
```

Between calls	Voice-to-text the details. Paste the output. Send the texts. Customer logged, review requested, relationship maintained. **2 minutes per job.**

Evening: 5 Minutes Before You're Off the Clock

Last thing before dinner. Quick pipeline check:

COPY THIS PROMPT

```
End of day review. Here are my open items:

Quotes given today: [list with amounts]
Leads still open: [list with last contact date]
Big jobs in pipeline: [any $3K+ proposals out]

What needs attention tomorrow? Draft any urgent follow-ups. Flag anything over 48 hours.
```

6:30 PM	Paste, review, schedule tomorrow's follow-ups. **Done by 6:35. You're off the clock.**

Weekly: Sunday Night, 20 Minutes

Step 1	**Marketing batch:** Paste your monthly content prompts from Chapter 4. Get the week's posts ready. (10 min)
Step 2	**Pipeline review:** Who's got an open quote? Who needs a seasonal check-in? Run the maintenance flag prompt from Chapter 3. (5 min)
Step 3	**Plan the week:** What's on the schedule? Any big proposals to follow up on? (5 min)

The Compound Effect

Week 1

Feels weird. Do it anyway. Save 3-4 hours.

Month 1

Close 1-2 extra jobs from follow-ups alone.

Month 3

Google reviews climbing. Phone rings more. Shoulder season isn't dead.

Month 6

Can't imagine going back. Revenue up 20-30%. Stress down.

DON'T TRY EVERYTHING AT ONCE

Week 1: Just do the lead follow-ups (Chapter 2). Get comfortable with the prompts.

Week 2: Add the post-job logging and review requests.

Week 3: Start the morning prep routine.

Week 4: Add the monthly marketing batch. You're running all five systems.

"Start with one system. Master it. Add the next. In a month, you've built an AI-powered business."

CLOSING

Go Build Something

Here's what you just built:

- A **Lead Capture System** that ensures no job slips through the cracks
- A **Customer Memory System** that makes you look like you have a full office staff
- A **Marketing Engine** that fills your schedule year-round
- A **Sales Closer System** that lands the big installs without being pushy
- A **Daily Operating System** that runs it all in 15 minutes

These aren't tricks. They're systems. You built them. You own them. They run on tools that cost $20/month or less. And they do the work of a dispatcher, an office manager, a marketing coordinator, and a sales rep - for a fraction of the cost.

The HVAC techs who grow are the ones who figured out how to handle the business side without drowning in it. You just did that.

Now go answer that lead. Follow up on that quote. Send that review request. The next job is waiting - and this time, you won't miss it.

5

Business systems built

15 min

Daily time investment

$0-20

Monthly cost to run it all

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